

ANDREW

Faith, I'll home to-morrow, Sir Toby: your niece will not be seen; or if she be, it's four to one she'll none of me: the count himself here hard by woos her.

TOBY

She'll none o' the count: she'll not match above her degree, neither in estate, years, nor wit; I have heard her swear't. Tut, there's life in't, man.

ANDREW

I'll stay a month longer. I am a fellow o' the strangest mind i' the world; I delight in masques and revels sometimes altogether.

TOBY

Art thou good at these kickshawses, knight?

ANDREW

As any man in Illyria, whatsoever he be, under the degree of my betters; and yet I will not compare with an old man.

TOBY

What is thy excellence in a galliard, knight?

ANDREW

Faith, I can cut a caper.

TOBY

And I can cut the mutton to't.

ANDREW

And I think I have the back-trick simply as strong as any man in Illyria.

TOBY

Wherefore are these things hid? wherefore have these gifts a curtain before 'em? are they like to take dust, like Mistress Mall's picture? why dost thou not go to church in a galliard and come home in a coranto? My very walk should be a jig; I would not so much as make water but in a sink-a-pace. What dost thou mean? Is it a world to hide virtues in? I

did think, by the excellent constitution of thy leg, it was formed under the star of a galliard.

ANDREW

Ay, 'tis strong, and it does indifferent well in a flame-coloured stock. Shall we set about some revels?

TOBY

What shall we do else? were we not born under Taurus?

ANDREW

Taurus! That's sides and heart.

TOBY

No, sir; it is legs and thighs. Let me see the caper, ha! higher: ha, ha! excellent!

(Exeunt omnes.)

(Exit MARIA.)

TOBY

O knight thou lackest a cup of canary: when did I see thee so put down?

ANDREW

Never in your life, I think; unless you see canary put me down. Methinks sometimes I have no more wit than a Christian or an ordinary man has: but I am a great eater of beef and I believe that does harm to my wit.

TOBY

No question.

ANDREW

An I thought that, I'd forswear it. I'll ride home to-morrow, Sir Toby.

TOBY

Pourquoi, my dear knight?

ANDREW

What is 'Pourquoi'? do or not do? I would I had bestowed that time in the tongues that I have in fencing, dancing and bear-baiting: O, had I but followed the arts!

TOBY

Then hadst thou had an excellent head of hair.

ANDREW

Why, would that have mended my hair?

TOBY

Past question; for thou seest it will not curl by nature.

ANDREW

But it becomes me well enough, does't not?

TOBY

Excellent; it hangs like flax on a distaff; and I hope to see a housewife take thee between her legs and spin it off.

Twelfth Night

MARIA

Fare you well, gentlemen.

TOBY

An thou let part so, Sir Andrew, would thou mightst never draw sword again.

ANDREW

An you part so, mistress, I would I might never draw sword again. Fair lady, do you think you have fools in hand?

MARIA

Sir, I have not you by the hand.

ANDREW

Marry, but you shall have; and here's my hand.

MARIA

Now, sir, 'thought is free;' I pray you, bring your hand to the buttery-bar and let it drink.

ANDREW

Wherefore, sweet-heart? what's your metaphor?

MARIA

It's dry, sir.

ANDREW

Why, I think so: I am not such an ass but I can keep my hand dry. But what's your jest?

MARIA

A dry jest, sir.

ANDREW

Are you full of them?

MARIA

Ay, sir, I have them at my fingers' ends: marry, now I let go your hand, I am barren.

Scene 4

DUKE ORSINO's palace

(Enter VALENTINE and VIOLA in man's attire)

VALENTINE

If the duke continue these favours towards you, Cesario, you are like to be much advanced: he hath known you but three days, and already you are no stranger.

VIOLA

You either fear his humour or my negligence, that you call in question the continuance of his love: is he inconstant, sir, in his favours?

VALENTINE

No, believe me.

VIOLA

I thank you. Here comes the count.

(Enter DUKE ORSINO, CURIO and ATTENDANTS.)

ORSINO

Who saw Cesario, ho?

VIOLA

On your attendance, my lord; here.

ORSINO

Stand you a while aloof, Cesario,
Thou know'st no less but all: I have unclasp'd
To thee the book even of my secret soul:
Therefore, good youth, address thy gait unto her;
Be not denied access, stand at her doors,
And tell them, there thy fixed foot shall grow
Till thou have audience.

Twelfth Night

VIOLA

Sure, my noble lord,
If she be so abandon'd to her sorrow
As it is spoke, she never will admit me.

ORSINO

Be clamorous and leap all civil bounds
Rather than make unprofit'd return.

VIOLA

Say I do speak with her, my lord, what then?

ORSINO

O, then unfold the passion of my love,
Surprise her with discourse of my dear faith:
It shall become thee well to act my woes;
She will attend it better in thy youth
Than in a nuncio's of more grave aspect.

VIOLA

I think not so, my lord.

ORSINO

Dear lad, believe it;
For they shall yet belie thy happy years,
That say thou art a man: Diana's lip
Is not more smooth and rubious; thy small pipe
Is as the maiden's organ, shrill and sound,
And all is semblative a woman's part.
I know thy constellation is right apt
For this affair. Some four or five attend him;
All, if you will; for I myself am best
When least in company. Prosper well in this,
And thou shalt live as freely as thy lord,
To call his fortunes thine.



MY NAME IS MARY, SIR

Twelfth Night

(Enter SIR ANDREW AGUECHECK.)

ANDREW

Sir Toby Belch! how now, Sir Toby Belch!

TOBY

Sweet Sir Andrew!

ANDREW

Bless you, fair shrew.

MARIA

And you too, sir.

TOBY

Accost, Sir Andrew, accost.

ANDREW

What's that?

TOBY

My niece's chambermaid.

ANDREW

Good Mistress Accost, I desire better acquaintance.

MARIA

My name is Mary, sir.

ANDREW

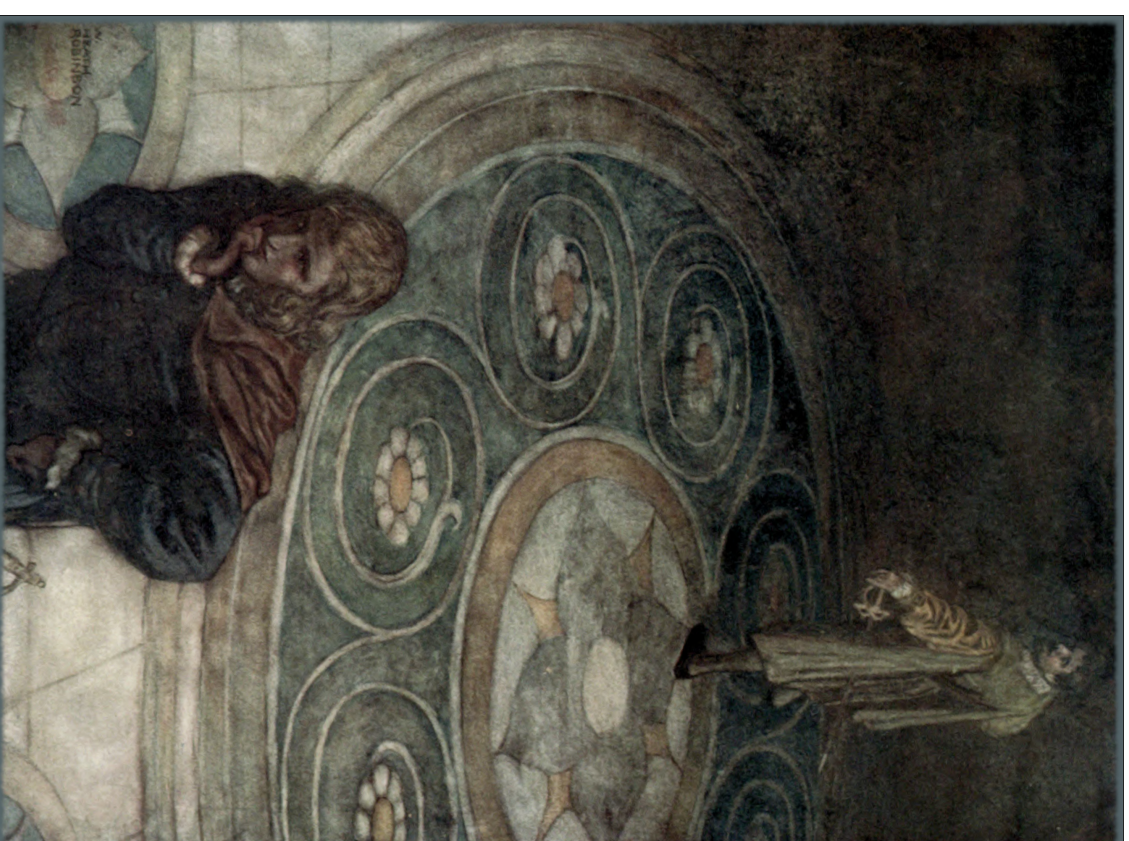
Good Mistress Mary Accost,—

TOBY

You mistake, knight; 'accost' is front her, board her, woo her, assail her.

ANDREW

By my troth, I would not undertake her in this company. Is that the meaning of 'accost'?



WHO'ER I WOO, MYSELF WOULD BE HIS WIFE

VIOLA

I'll do my best
To woo your lady:

[Aside] yet, a barful strife!
Whoe'er I woo, myself would be his wife.
(Exeunt omnes.)



DRINKING HEALTHS TO MY NIECE

Twelfth Night

TOBY

He's as tall a man as any's in Illyria.

MARIA

What's that to the purpose?

TOBY

Why, he has three thousand ducats a year.

MARIA

Ay, but he'll have but a year in all these ducats: he's a very fool and a prodigal.

TOBY

Fie, that you'll say so! he plays o' the viol-de-gamboys, and speaks three or four languages word for word without book, and hath all the good gifts of nature.

MARIA

He hath indeed, almost natural: for besides that he's a fool, he's a great quarreller: and but that he hath the gift of a coward to allay the gust he hath in quarrelling, 'tis thought among the prudent he would quickly have the gift of a grave.

TOBY

By this hand, they are scoundrels and subtractors that say so of him. Who are they?

MARIA

They that add, moreover, he's drunk nightly in your company.

TOBY

With drinking healths to my niece: I'll drink to her as long as there is a passage in my throat and drink in Illyria: he's a coward and a coxstrill that will not drink to my niece till his brains turn o' the toe like a parish-top. What, wench! Castiliano vulgo! for here comes Sir Andrew Agueface.

Scene 5

OLIVIA'S house

(Enter MARIA and FESTE.)

MARIA

Nay, either tell me where thou hast been, or I will not open my lips so wide as a bristle may enter in way of thy excuse: my lady will hang thee for thy absence.

FESTE

Let her hang me: he that is well hanged in this world needs to fear no colours.

MARIA

Make that good.

FESTE

He shall see none to fear.

MARIA

A good lenten answer: I can tell thee where that saying was born, of 'I fear no colours.'

FESTE

Where, good Mistress Mary?

MARIA

In the wars; and that may you be bold to say in your foolery.

FESTE

Well, God give them wisdom that have it; and those that are fools, let them use their talents.

MARIA

Yet you will be hanged for being so long absent; or, to be turned away, is not that as good as a hanging to you?



Scene 3

OLIVIA's house

(Enter Sir Toby Belch and Maria.)

TOBY

What a plague means my niece, to take the death of her brother thus? I am sure care's an enemy to life.

MARIA

By my troth, Sir Toby, you must come in earlier o' nights: your cousin, my lady, takes great exceptions to your ill hours.

TOBY

Why, let her except, before excepted.

MARIA

Ay, but you must confine yourself within the modest limits of order.

TOBY

Confine! I'll confine myself no finer than I am: these clothes are good enough to drink in; and so be these boots too: an they be not, let them hang themselves in their own straps.

MARIA

That quaffing and drinking will undo you: I heard my lady talk of it yesterday; and of a foolish knight that you brought in one night here to be her wooer.

TOBY

Who, Sir Andrew Aguecheek?

MARIA

Ay, he.

YOU WILL BE HANGED FOR BEING SO LONG ABSENT